



CD-WRITING

CD writers are an invaluable tool for backing up your data. You can make audio and video CDs—and there are a hundred other uses you can think up for CDs.

Nero 6 is the latest from Ahead Software. It sports a new interface—Nero Express. All wizards that were in the previous versions have been removed, but Nero Express is a user-friendly interface that provides easy access to all features. Nero 6 comes with comprehensive documentation explaining all the features and functionalities available. It supports almost all popular CD formats. It even supports the HFS file system, so you can burn CDs in the MAC format. A disadvantage we found with Nero 6 was its lack of network browsing capability—you need to use Windows Explorer to drag files onto your compilation.

You can easily create ISO images using Nero, and you can burn bootable and regular CDs from ISO and CUE images. A novel feature is support for Mini DVD discs—you can write onto these small form factor—3¼ inch—DVD discs which

Nero 6 Ultra Edition

+ Powerful features, backup creation tool, copy protection for audio CDs

– Disk spanning not supported

Price: \$59.99

Web site: www.nero.com

Reviewed In: October 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: NA

2001: Easy CD Creator 5 Platinum

hold up to 1.4 GB of data. It also supports multiple recorders, so you can create multiple copies of a disc simultaneously, as well as packet writing through IN CD or Direct CD, for convenient drag-and-drop CDRW writing. Another good feature in Nero 6 is the addition of a virus checker and a backup tool. You can even create copy protected audio CDs using Nero 6—

WORTHY MENTIONS

Pinnacle Instant CD/ DVD

+ Easy to use wizards, inbuilt audio and video editors

– Doesn't support overburning

Price: \$99.99

Web site: www.pinnaclesys.com

Reviewed In: October 2003

Roxio Easy CD/DVD Creator 6

+ Excellent interface, supports disk spanning

– Doesn't support overburning, HFS not supported

Price: \$69.95

Web site: www.roxio.com

Reviewed In: October 2003

this excellent feature is absent in all other software; the same goes for its virus checking feature. By adding a new, improved interface, Nero has become more appealing for novice users, but it is not as user-friendly as Easy CD/DVD. For advanced users, however, it supports several options like overburning, changing buffer size, and so on. That's what makes Nero 6 an all-rounder.

DATA BACKUP

Backup software let you backup data to a safe place—on another hard disk, or across the network—so that you aren't left out in the cold when you lose those precious bytes of information.

Norton Ghost has a very easy-to-use interface. Wizards guide you through all tasks without exposing the intricacies. All tasks are grouped under three categories—Ghost Basic, Ghost Advanced and Ghost Utilities. Under Ghost Basic come all the basic backup and restore tasks. Ghost Utilities consists of the Norton Ghost Boot Wizard that helps in creating a boot disk, for various scenarios like restore from removable media, restore from shared folders, or restore from peer-to-peer network. A Peer-to-Peer Wizard eases the task of backing up or restoring between two PCs.

Norton Ghost supports removable storage media such as CD, DVD, USB drives, Zip drives and Firewire, onto which the hard disk image can be transferred. It even supports creation of

Norton Ghost 2003

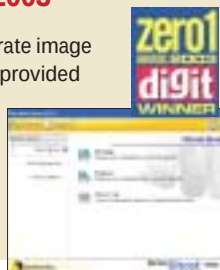
+ Feature rich, separate image integrity check tool provided

– Slow operation

Price: Rs 2,632

Web site: www.symantec.com

Reviewed In: November 2003



PREVIOUS WINNERS

2002: NA

2001: NA

images across a network. Thanks to the Image Integrity Check tool, you need not wait till you have to urgently restore the PC, to find that the image is corrupted. Browse the contents of the image of a suspicious piece of software using the Norton Ghost Explorer. The explorer also comes in handy when the image is corrupted and a few important files need to be extracted.

WORTHY MENTIONS

WinBackup

+ Security, spanning across media

– Backed-up data is not secured by default

Price: \$39.95

Web site: www.liutilities.com

Reviewed In: November 2003

GoBack 3.0

+ Very fast, utilises 10 per cent of hard disk space

– Monitors entire drive, users do not have the freedom of creating safe points manually

Price: \$29.95

Web site: www.symantec.com

Reviewed In: November 2003

One of its utilities—the GDisk utility—can be used to create and manage partitions.

Norton Ghost was a tad slow in terms of time taken to create an image. However, it compressed the resulting image file to 52 per cent of its original size. →